

Reading Nook Story Cause-and-Effect Card Pack

Sixteen paper cards help writers connect a pretend reading nook cause to a clear fictional result.

Audience: Families, homeschool groups, tutors, and adult-led writing tables for writers ages 7-11.

Format: 16 printable story cause-and-effect cards plus adult guide tools, cause/effect routines, take-home cause/effect slips, and optional share prompts

Family-safe printable writing pages for adult-led, offline story practice.



\$41

Included

- 16 printable reading-nook cause-and-effect cards
- Adult setup guide
- Fictional cause/effect safety notes
- Cause/effect coaching moves
- Privacy and family handoff notes
- Pack reset notes
- Six adult-led cause/effect routines
- Ten take-home cause/effect slips
- Eight optional share prompts
- Provider-ready PDF and ZIP artifact

Cause/effect move coaching

Before the session

- Lay out paper cause cards, effect cards, blank cover shapes, cushion corner labels, and pencils before writers arrive.
- Explain that every reading nook detail is pretend and paper-only, not a report about any real reading item or person.
- Invite each writer to choose one cozy prop card, such as lamp glow, paper bookmark, or soft rug sketch.
- Keep blank lines short so writers ages 7-11 can finish one clear cause and one result at a time.
- Place extra because, so, and then arrow strips near the adult guide spot for quick help.

Privacy and safety notes

- Keep all work on paper and within the adult-led group.
- Use pretend role labels when a label is needed.
- Keep every blank cover shape invented, with no actual reading labels.
- This paper pack keeps finished pages with the family adult.
- Collect slips at the end only if families choose to keep them in the folder.

Paper cause/effect setup

- Put cause cards on the left and effect cards on the right with a wide arrow lane between them.
- Use one pretend page card as the shared story space for the group.
- Add small paper tokens for cushion squeak, lamp glow, blanket fold, and paper bookmark.
- Keep a discard stack for silly ideas that do not fit the current chain.
- Give each writer one blank pair card so the adult can model cause first, effect second.

Family handoff

- Send one slip with one clear blank line, not a long worksheet.
- Tell families the card is for a short paper story talk led by an adult.
- Invite the writer to explain the cause first, then the effect, using the paper arrow.
- Ask adults to praise the link, not spelling or neatness.
- Return any unused cards to the folder so the next table can use them.

Story cause/effect coaching

- Ask, What changed first, and what happened right after it?
- Point to the paper arrow and have the writer say because before filling the line.
- If the effect feels too broad, ask for one tiny visible result on the pretend page.
- If a cause feels missing, offer two paper prop choices and let the writer pick one.
- Read the pair aloud once and check that the effect could happen because of that cause.

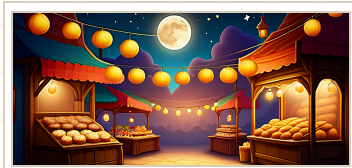
Reset

- Sort cause, effect, arrow, and prop cards into separate paper stacks.
- Recycle torn blanks and keep clean blanks for the next group.
- Clear adult examples if one was used; keep no writer details.
- Put the reading nook labels back in the envelope with pencils and arrow strips.

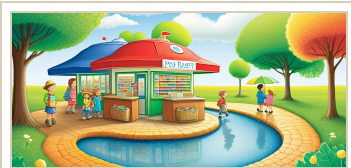
Use one paper cause/effect card at a time. Keep every choice broad, invented, and screen-free.

Sixteen cause-and-effect-card worlds

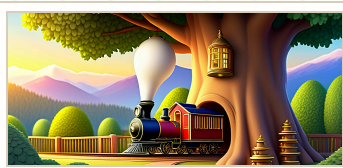
Pick a world image, then connect one invented reading nook cause to one story effect.



AGES 6-8
Moon Muffin Market



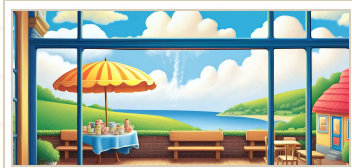
AGES 6-8
Puddle Planet Post Office



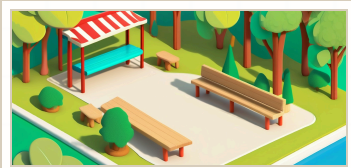
AGES 7-9
Buttonwood Library Train



AGES 7-9
Button Bakery Map Mix-Up



AGES 7-8
Teacup Town Weather Window



AGES 7-9
Pocket Park Notice Board



AGES 7-9
Spoon Ferry Lunchbox Harbor



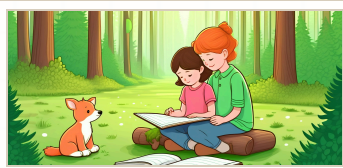
AGES 7-9
Acorn Avenue Errand Office



AGES 8-10
Seed Library Map Room



AGES 8-10
Rain Gauge Railway



AGES 8-10
Moss Message Observatory



AGES 8-10
Tidepool Timekeepers Lab



AGES 10-11
Revision River Ferry



AGES 10-11
Clue Label Tower Museum



AGES 10-11
Compass Craft Academy



AGES 10-11
Binding Day Boardwalk

Choose the paper cause/effect rhythm

Lamp Glow Because Pair Writers who need one simple cause and one direct effect. 1. Adult places a lamp glow card on the cause side. 2. Writer chooses one effect card that could happen on the pretend page. 3. Together, say the sentence with because and point across the arrow. 4. Writer copies the pair onto a blank cover shape and adds one cozy detail.	Cushion Corner So Chain Small groups ready to link three paper events. 1. Place a cushion corner card, an arrow, and two blank effect cards in a row. 2. Adult fills the first cause with a tiny change, such as the cushion squeaks. 3. Each writer adds one so result that follows the card before it. 4. Read the chain once and remove any card that does not follow clearly.
Paper Bookmark Choice Turn Character-choice cause practice without personal data. 1. Put two paper bookmark choice cards face up. 2. Writer picks one pretend character action, such as saving a page or moving a ribbon. 3. Adult asks what the action changes in the reading nook scene. 4. Writer writes the direct effect on the matching card.	Blank Cover Object Clue Linking an object to a story result. 1. Adult shows one blank cover shape and three object cards. 2. Writer chooses the object that causes the clearest change. 3. Group names the effect in five words or fewer. 4. Writer draws an arrow from object to effect and reads it aloud.
Pretend Page Problem Path Turning a mild paper problem into a clean result. 1. Place one pretend page problem card in the center. 2. Adult asks what caused the problem inside the fictional page. 3. Writer adds a paper cause card to the left. 4. Writer adds one result to the right that solves or changes the problem.	Soft Rug Reaction Link Practicing how a character reacts after something happens. 1. Adult places a soft rug event card and a reaction card together. 2. Writer says what happened first using one clear cause. 3. Writer chooses a calm reaction effect that fits the event. 4. Adult helps turn both parts into one because sentence.

Finish one story cause-and-effect later

ONE-CARD SLIP CLEAR CAUSE Lamp Glow Cause Card Choose one pretend reading nook change and write what caused it: _____. Adult asks, What happened because of that cause: _____.	BECAUSE SLIP BECAUSE STATEMENT Cushion Because Line Finish the sentence: The cushion corner changed because _____. Adult reads the line aloud and asks for one matching effect: _____.
SO SLIP SO RESULT Paper Bookmark So Result Write a cause, then add so to show the result: _____. Adult asks whether the result follows the cause: _____.	CHAIN SLIP CAUSE-AND-EFFECT CHAIN Three Card Chain Make a three-card chain with cause, effect, and next effect: _____. Adult points to each arrow while the writer explains: _____.
EFFECT ARROW SLIP DIRECT EFFECT Lamp Arrow Match Draw an arrow from a lamp glow cause to one direct effect: _____. Adult asks the writer to say the arrow sentence: _____.	CHOICE SLIP CHARACTER CHOICE CAUSE Bookmark Choice Cause Pick one pretend character choice in the nook and show what it changes: _____. Adult asks why that choice caused the effect: _____.
SETTING SLIP SETTING EFFECT Cozy Setting Effect Use cushion corner, soft rug, or lamp glow as the setting cause: _____. Adult asks what changes because the setting is that way: _____.	OBJECT SLIP OBJECT CAUSE Object Makes It Happen Choose paper bookmark, blank cover shape, or folded note as the object cause: _____. Adult asks what the object makes happen on the pretend page: _____.
PROBLEM-RESULT SLIP PROBLEM CAUSE Tiny Problem Cause Write a tiny paper problem and the cause behind it: _____. Adult asks for one gentle result that follows: _____.	FINAL RESULT SLIP FINAL RESULT Final Result Link Finish a cause-and-effect chain with the final result: _____. Adult asks which first cause led to the ending: _____.

Optional share prompts

- My clearest cause was _____.
- The effect that followed was _____.
- My because sentence is _____.
- My so sentence is _____.
- The reading nook prop that caused a change was _____.
- The pretend page changed when _____.
- One effect in my chain led to _____.
- The final result of my cozy story chain was _____.

Moon Muffin Tray Wobble

Adult setup: Place the paper card beside a pretend page, a paper bookmark, and one blank cover shape, then point to the moon muffin tray clue: _____.

Read the tiny market moment, choose the one clear cause, and write it in the lamp glow space: _____.



Moon Muffin Market

Cause prompt
What made the moon muffin tray wobble at the paper counter: _____.

Effect prompt
What happened right after the tray wobbled: _____.

Because prompt
Finish the sentence: The tray wobbled because _____.

So prompt
Finish the sentence: The tray wobbled, so _____.

Chain prompt
Link the first cause to the next tiny market event: _____.

Check back
Check back to the pretend page and circle the clue that proves your cause: _____.

Quiet option
Quiet option: whisper the cause to the adult leader, then write only the key words: _____.

Carry-away line: use the same moon muffin cause with a new paper-card effect: _____.

Puddle Planet Envelope Plop

Adult setup: Set out the card with a pretend page, paper envelope shape, and lamp glow marker, then read the puddle clue aloud: _____.

Look at the cause on the paper card and write the direct effect that would happen next: _____.



Puddle Planet Post Office

Cause prompt
Cause: the puddle stamp slid off the envelope shape; add one detail that explains why: _____.

Because prompt
Finish the sentence: The stamp slid away because _____.

Chain prompt
Make a short chain from stamp slip to envelope change: _____.

Quiet option
Quiet option: point to the direct effect first, then copy it into the blank: _____.

Effect prompt
What direct effect happens when the puddle stamp slides away: _____.

So prompt
Finish the sentence: The puddle stamp slid away, so _____.

Check back
Check back to the paper clue and tell which effect matches it best: _____.

Carry-away line: draw a new envelope shape and give it one direct effect: _____.

Buttonwood Library Train Pause

Adult setup: Place the card near a blank cover shape and a paper bookmark, then invite the writer to notice the train pause clue: _____.

Write a full because statement that connects the train pause to one invented cause: _____.



Buttonwood Library Train

Cause prompt
What caused the Buttonwood Library Train to pause by the cushion shelf: _____.

Effect prompt
What changed in the quiet rail scene after the train paused: _____.

Because prompt
Finish the sentence: The Buttonwood Library Train paused because _____.

So prompt
Finish the sentence: The train paused, so _____.

Chain prompt
Add one more linked step after the pause: _____.

Check back
Check your because statement against the pretend page clue and fix one word if needed: _____.

Quiet option
Quiet option: say the because statement softly, then write the final version: _____.

Carry-away line: make another rail-scene because statement on a fresh paper card: _____.

Button Bakery Paper Map Mixup

Adult setup: Lay the card beside a pretend page and a tiny paper path map, then mark the button bakery mixup clue: _____.

Read the cause, then write the result that begins after the word so: _____.



Button Bakery Map Mix-Up

Cause prompt
What caused the button bakery paper path map to turn the wrong way: _____.

Effect prompt
What changed at the paper counter after the map turned the wrong way: _____.

Because prompt
Finish the sentence: The path map turned the wrong way because _____.

So prompt
Finish the sentence: The path map turned the wrong way, so _____.

Chain prompt
Add one more result after your so sentence: _____.

Check back
Check back to the blank cover shape scene and underline the result clue: _____.

Quiet option
Quiet option: choose the so result from two adult-read choices, then write it: _____.

Carry-away line: reuse the paper path map with a new so result: _____.

Teacup Town Weather Window

Adult setup: Set the card near a pretend page and choose one paper weather window setting before the writer adds the effect: _____.

Name the setting first, then tell what effect it has on the Teacup Town scene: _____.



Teacup Town Weather Window

Cause prompt

What setting detail appears in the Teacup Town weather window: _____.

Because prompt

Finish the sentence: The scene changed because the weather window showed _____.

Chain prompt

Connect setting to action to final nook detail: _____.

Quiet option

Quiet option: point to the setting picture, then write only the effect words: _____.

Effect prompt

What effect does that setting have on the paper teacup cart or cushion corner: _____.

So prompt

Finish the sentence: The weather window changed the setting, so _____.

Check back

Check back to the pretend page and make sure the effect fits the setting: _____.

Carry-away line: try a different paper weather window and write its effect: _____.

Pocket Park Notice Board Chain

Adult setup: Place the fictional notice board card beside a paper bookmark and blank cover shape, then model one cause leading to one effect: _____.

Write a cause, its effect, and the next effect so the pocket park chain makes sense: _____.



Pocket Park Notice Board

Cause prompt
What first cause appears on the pocket park notice board slip: _____.

Effect prompt
What effect happens right after that first cause: _____.

Because prompt
Finish the sentence: The pocket park changed because _____.

So prompt
Finish the sentence: The first notice slip changed, so _____.

Chain prompt
Build the chain: first cause, first effect, next effect: _____.

Check back
Check back to the pretend page and make sure each link follows from the one before it: _____.

Quiet option
Quiet option: tap each paper link in order before writing the chain: _____.

Carry-away line: fold a fresh paper card and make a new three-link chain: _____.

Spoon Ferry Lunchbox Harbor

Adult setup: Place the paper card near a blank cover shape and ask the writer to choose one object for the spoon ferry to carry: _____.

Write what the object does first, then write the story effect that happens next in the pretend page scene: _____.



Spoon Ferry Lunchbox Harbor

Cause prompt
Object cause: The spoon ferry's special cargo is _____.

Effect prompt
Effect: When that cargo tips, slides, or shines, the harbor changes by _____.

Because prompt
Because the object _____, the crumb dock crew decides to _____.

So prompt
So the ferry guide changes the crossing path by _____.

Chain prompt
Chain it: object, ferry choice, harbor effect; write the middle link: _____.

Check back
Check back: Does the final effect clearly happen because of _____.

Quiet option
Quiet option: Draw the object on a paper bookmark and label its effect _____.

Carry-away line: Tell the spoon ferry cause-and-effect story with one because sentence about _____.

Acorn Avenue Errand Office

Adult setup: Set the card in the cushion corner and choose a pretend clerk, messenger, or tray keeper together: _____.

Write the character's choice first, then write what changes in the paper office because of it: _____.



Acorn Avenue Errand Office

Cause prompt
Character choice cause: The acorn clerk chooses to sort _____ first.

Effect prompt
Effect: Because of that choice, the errand office _____.

Because prompt
Because the character chooses _____, another worker notices _____.

So prompt
So the paper errand changes in this way: _____.

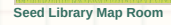
Chain prompt
Chain it: choice, office reaction, new errand result; add the missing reaction: _____.

Check back
Check back: Can the effect happen only after the character chooses _____.

Quiet option
Quiet option: Fold a tiny paper ticket and write the choice on it: _____.

Carry-away line: Retell the errand-office cause using because and so with _____.

Write the problem first, then show how it causes the next map-room effect in the pretend page: _____.



Because prompt

Because the problem _____, the map room changes by _____.

Chain it: problem, first effect, second effect; write the link that makes the chain make sense:
_____.

Quiet option: Sketch two paper map squares and mark the one that causes _____.

So the next clue appears on _____.

Check back: Underline the problem that causes _____.

Carry-away line: Explain the seed-library problem in one because sentence about _____.

Rain Gauge Railway

Adult setup: Place a paper strip as the railway line beside the card and name one make-believe rain-gauge signal: _____.

Write the reaction first, then explain the effect that follows in the railway story: _____.



Rain Gauge Railway

Cause prompt
Reaction cause: When the gauge card tilts, the conductor reacts by _____.

Effect prompt
Effect: That reaction makes the paper train _____.

Because prompt
Because the conductor reacts by _____, the platform crew changes _____.

So prompt
So the rain-gauge railway scene ends with _____.

Chain prompt
Chain it: signal, reaction, effect; add the reaction that connects both sides: _____.

Check back
Check back: Does the final effect clearly grow from the reaction to _____.

Quiet option
Quiet option: Draw one arrow from the reaction card to _____.

Carry-away line: Say the railway effect aloud using because or so with _____.

Moss Message Observatory

Adult setup: Set the card near a paper telescope strip and remind the writer the observatory exists only in the reading nook: _____.

Find the first cause before writing later effects, then keep the chain in order on the paper card: _____.



Moss Message Observatory

Cause prompt
First cause: The moss on the lens changes when _____.

Effect prompt
Effect: That first change makes the observer notice _____.

Because prompt
Because the first cause is _____, the moss message later _____.

So prompt
So the observatory helper decides to _____.

Chain prompt
Chain it: first cause, message change, final choice; write the first cause again: _____.

Check back
Check back: If you remove the first cause, which effect would disappear: _____.

Quiet option
Quiet option: Put a small box around the first cause on the pretend page: _____.

Carry-away line: Retell the moss-message chain beginning with the first cause: _____.

Tidepool Lab Final Shell

Adult setup: Print the card, set a paper bookmark beside the lamp glow, and point to the last blank as the final result space: _____.

Read the invented cause, then write what finally changes on the pretend page: _____.



Tidepool Timekeepers Lab

Cause prompt
Cause: The tidepool lab crew moves the shell marker from the gray tray to _____.

Effect prompt
Effect: The direct change on the pretend page is _____.

Because prompt
Because the shell marker changes places, the lab note now says _____.

So prompt
So the final result at the cushion corner is _____.

Chain prompt
Chain: shell marker moves, label changes, final result becomes _____.

Check back
Look back: Does your final result answer what changed after the first cause: _____.

Quiet option
Quiet option: Circle the cause and write only the final result in the blank: _____.

Carry-away line: On another paper slip, write one cause and its final result: _____.

Revision River Because Ferry

Adult setup: Print the card, draw two paper ferry docks, and choose one plain pretend sentence to improve: _____.

Write a because statement that explains why the ferry sentence changes before it lands: _____.



Revision River Ferry

Cause prompt
Cause: The Revision River ferry finds a foggy detail beside _____.

Effect prompt
Effect: The sentence becomes clearer when _____.

Because prompt
Because the ferry swaps the foggy detail for a sharper one, _____.

So prompt
So the far-dock sentence now helps the reader picture _____.

Chain prompt
Chain: foggy detail appears, ferry pauses, clearer detail arrives because _____.

Check back
Look back: Does your because statement connect one cause to one clear effect: _____.

Quiet option
Quiet option: Write only the words after because, then read the full sentence softly: _____.

Carry-away line: Fold a paper slip and write one because statement for a pretend page: _____.

Clue Label Direct Result

Adult setup: Print the card, stack three blank label shapes, and remind the writer that every clue is invented: _____.

Name the one effect that happens right after the clue label changes places: _____.



Clue Label Tower Museum

Cause prompt
Cause: The tower guide moves the blue clue label beside _____.

Effect prompt
Effect: The direct result is that the next label now shows _____.

Because prompt
Because the blue clue label moved, the paper exhibit points to _____.

So prompt
So the reader can tell that the first clue directly caused _____.

Chain prompt
Chain: label moves, clue points, direct effect appears as _____.

Check back
Look back: Did you choose the effect that happens right after the label move: _____.

Quiet option
Quiet option: Draw one arrow from the cause label to the direct effect label: _____.

Carry-away line: Use two paper scraps to show a cause and its direct effect: _____.

Compass Craft Choice Cause

Adult setup: Print the card, place a blank cover shape under the lamp glow, and draw a small paper compass dial: _____.

Choose what the compass maker decides, then explain what that choice causes next: _____.



Compass Craft Academy

Cause prompt
Cause: The compass maker chooses _____ for the center mark.

Effect prompt
Effect: That choice makes the paper compass point toward _____.

Because prompt
Because the character picked that center mark, the compass craft now _____.

So prompt
So the academy page changes by adding _____.

Chain prompt
Chain: character choice, compass shift, new story result: _____.

Check back
Look back: Can the effect happen only because of the character choice you wrote: _____.

Quiet option
Quiet option: Draw the compass choice first, then write the caused result: _____.

Carry-away line: Make a tiny paper compass and name one choice that causes a result: _____.

Binding Day Paper Chain

Adult setup: Print the card, fold three pretend pages, and place them in a small paper stack near the cushion corner: _____.

Write each cause and effect so one result becomes the next cause in the chain: _____.



Binding Day Boardwalk

Cause prompt
Cause: On Binding Day, the first loose page slides beside _____.

Effect prompt
Effect: The paper helper notices _____ and changes the page order.

Because prompt
Because the page order changes, the blank cover shape now needs _____.

So prompt
So the next boardwalk step is _____.

Chain prompt
Chain: loose page, changed order, cover fix, final page result: _____.

Check back
Look back: Does each effect become the reason for the next step in your chain: _____.

Quiet option
Quiet option: Use arrows between four short phrases instead of full sentences: _____.

Carry-away line: Stack three scrap pages and write a cause-and-effect chain for them: _____.